

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments product manager for global SaaS platforms.*

Positioning, I've shipped payment infrastructure, owned gateway integrations, and taken a P2P fintech product from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem.

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§ WHY THRIVECART

ThriveCart is solving a real problem: checkout and billing friction that costs creators and merchants money on every transaction. The explicit scope here, gateway integrations, fraud, reconciliation, local payment methods, PSD2, SCA, is the kind of end-to-end payments ownership I find most interesting, not just the user-facing layer. The fact that ThriveCart is also exploring AI tooling alongside payments infrastructure means there's room to work at both levels. *That combination is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day development assist
- **Cursor**, in-editor refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **GPT**, research and drafting
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitOps, CI/CD, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace that takes the headhunter out of construction hiring.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents automate the day-to-day funnel.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one person runs operations end to end.
 - Directly relevant to ThriveCart: I designed the payment gate and commitment flow from scratch, and the billing model is the product.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THRIVECART

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I shadow support tickets, read existing gateway integration docs, and map the current checkout and reconciliation flows so I know where conversion is leaking before I touch the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Prioritise and slice.

I bring the findings to engineering and agree on the two or three highest-impact items, likely friction in the checkout funnel or a gap in a local payment method, and slice them to shippable size.

WEEK 3+

Ship and measure.

I get the first slice live, instrument it, and close the loop with the data. Then repeat with the next highest-priority item.

I COVER LETTER

Dear ThriveCart team,

I've been building and owning payment products for most of my career. My company Kvitt Payment Solutions was a mobile P2P fintech that ran inside the girocard ecosystem and was eventually acquired and operated by Sparkasse. That meant I had to understand gateway integration, settlement flows, chargeback handling, and the regulatory constraints that come with operating inside a card network, not as a user of someone else's product, but as the person responsible for the whole stack.

More recently at Scheidt & Bachmann, I owned the integration team for POS and forecourt payment systems in a SAFe environment, moving research results into production across a matrix organisation. I've also worked on the B2B SaaS side: at EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week, restructuring an 18-person delivery organisation in the process.

The ThriveCart posting calls out gateway integrations with Stripe, PayPal, and Authorize.net, local payment methods, PSD2 and SCA compliance, and a data-driven approach to conversion. These are things I have hands-on experience with, and the combination of checkout-side conversion work and back-end reconciliation and treasury is the kind of full-stack payments ownership I'm looking for. I also build with AI tools daily, Claude Code, n8n, GitHub Copilot, so the requirement for experience building AI agents is a natural fit rather than something I need to learn.

What draws me to ThriveCart specifically is the scale of the problem: a SaaS platform with a large creator and merchant base, where payment reliability and conversion rate improvements have a direct and measurable effect on user revenue. That's a product surface where instrumentation, tight feedback loops, and careful prioritisation actually move the needle.

I'd welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to what you're building.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership across fintech, payments, SaaS, insurance, and public-sector analytics. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P fintech acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, and have owned payment integration, gateway, and checkout products across multiple roles. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user needs into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving almost 75% of time per data update on quarterly imports and new indicators.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers, putting the team in autonomous control of its own environments.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL &
CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

Government, secure data platform. Identity management for the Robert Koch Institute.

- Owned data structures and identity management for the DIM and DESH programmes.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop built on Shopware.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects each side until commitment; LLM agents run the day-to-day funnel; conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Integrated hardware and software for quantum-secure encryption.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise buyer constraints. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero, taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Payments and Fintech: gateway integrations (Stripe, PayPal, girocard ecosystem), P2P payment flows, checkout and conversion optimisation, POS and forecourt payment systems, PSP integration product design, subscription and recurring billing concepts, PCI/PSD2/SCA regulatory awareness.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support, data-driven iteration.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, ART, PI planning.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · THRIVECART

